QUEENS PEACE PALACE

THE SELF-SABOTAGE RESET

A Guided Reflection for Recognizing the Pattern,
Understanding the Protection & Choosing Differently

RECOGNIZE. UNDERSTAND. CHOOSE AGAIN.

TO THY OWN SELF BE TRUE

The Inner Work Collection

Before You Begin

Self-sabotage is the name we often give to patterns that interfere with what we say we want: procrastinating, withdrawing, talking ourselves out of opportunities, choosing relationships that do not fit, or creating conditions that make success harder to reach. Sometimes the pattern is obvious. Sometimes it hides inside habits that once helped us feel safer or more in control.

The original Queens Peace Palace worksheet explored fear of failure, negative self-talk, control, relationship patterns and procrastination as common contributors. This new edition keeps that foundation, but moves the focus from simply identifying the behavior to understanding what the behavior may be doing for you.

> **This is not about shaming yourself.**
> A pattern can be unhelpful now and still have made sense at another point in your life. The goal is to see it clearly enough that you can make a more intentional choice.

A note on support

This workbook is for personal reflection and education. It is not therapy, diagnosis, or crisis care. If these reflections bring up experiences that feel overwhelming, unsafe, or difficult to manage alone, consider working with a licensed mental-health professional or another qualified source of support.

YOUR INTENTION

What would you like to understand, shift, or stop repeating by the time you finish this workbook?

What keeps happening?

Before you can change a pattern, you have to be able to name it without dressing it up, minimizing it, or turning it into a character judgment.

What is something you keep saying you want, while your actions repeatedly move you away from it?

Where does the pattern show up most?

- ■ Work, goals or creative projects
- ■ Money or opportunities
- ■ Romantic relationships
- ■ Friendships or family relationships
- ■ Self-care, routines or consistency
- ■ Being visible, receiving attention or being recognized
- ■ Making decisions or following through
- ■ Other: _____

What do you usually do right before the pattern repeats?

What might this pattern be protecting?

Self-sabotaging behavior can sometimes create a temporary sense of protection: if you do not try, you cannot fail; if you stay guarded, you cannot be rejected as easily; if you control the ending, uncertainty feels smaller. The protection may be costly, but understanding it can make the pattern easier to interrupt.

When this pattern takes over, what does it help you avoid feeling or facing?

- ■ Failure
- ■ Rejection
- ■ Disappointment
- ■ Being judged
- ■ Being seen
- ■ Losing control
- ■ Responsibility
- ■ Vulnerability
- ■ Success changing my life
- ■ Not knowing what happens next
- ■ Something else: _____

If this behavior could speak, what would it say it is trying to protect you from?

When do you remember first learning that this kind of protection was useful?

What is the pattern costing you?

A coping strategy can provide short-term relief while quietly creating a long-term cost. Seeing both sides helps you decide whether the pattern still deserves the role it has in your life.

In the short term, this pattern gives me…

In the long term, this pattern costs me…

What has it already delayed, damaged, complicated, or kept out of reach?

Palace Reflection
You do not have to hate the version of you that learned the pattern in order to outgrow the pattern.

Say the part you usually avoid.

This page is intentionally simple. Do not try to make your answers impressive. Write the first honest thing that comes up, then read it back slowly.

If I stopped sabotaging this area of my life, I would have to finally face…

If I actually got what I say I want, I am afraid that…

The story I keep telling myself is…

What I know underneath that story is…

Build a different response.

Change becomes more practical when you decide what you will do at the moment the old pattern appears. The replacement does not need to be dramatic. It needs to be specific enough that you can recognize and choose it.

MY OLD LOOP

Trigger → Thought → Usual behavior → Immediate relief → Long-term consequence

MY NEW RESPONSE

Trigger → Pause → More honest thought → Intentional action → What this protects/builds instead

The smallest action I can take within the next 24 hours is…

When I feel myself slipping into the old pattern, I want to remember…

Change the way you speak to yourself.

The original worksheet used affirmations to challenge self-defeating thoughts. In this edition, the goal is not to force positivity. Choose language you can actually return to when the pattern gets loud.

Try these:

“I can feel afraid and still move forward.”

“My actions can become more aligned with my intentions.”

“I do not have to create the ending before life has a chance to unfold.”

“I can protect myself without abandoning what I want.”

“I am learning to become an ally to my own growth.”

Now write three that sound like YOU.

1.

2.

3.

Which one do you most need to practice believing through action?

Turn insight into a decision.

Complete these without overthinking:

One pattern I am no longer willing to romanticize, excuse, or ignore is…

One thing I need more support with is…

One boundary that would make self-sabotage harder is…

One promise I can realistically keep to myself this week is…

THE PALACE CHECK-IN
When you revisit this page, do not ask only, “Did I do everything perfectly?” Ask: “Did I notice sooner? Did I choose differently at least once? Did I tell myself the truth?”

RETURN TO YOURSELF

You are allowed to outgrow what once protected you.

The goal of inner work is not to become a person who never struggles. It is to know yourself well enough to recognize when an old pattern is making a new decision for you.

Your next step does not have to be huge.
Choose one place where your actions can become a little more honest, a little more aligned, and a little more supportive of the life you say you want.

Need support going deeper?

If this reflection uncovered something you would like support navigating, Queens Peace Palace offers private Spiritual Life Coaching for clarity, self-trust, relationships, transitions and personal growth.

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